

Gligoric System - 7.Be3 before castling

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. Be3 Ng4 8. Bg5 f6

YOUR BLACK REPERTOIRE CHOICE

Use ...Ng4 to question the bishop before White gets an ideal flexible setup. Track White's choice of Bg5, Bc1, or a central exchange.



Main study anchor - White to move

READ THE CENTER

The center is still fluid. The f6 knight can attack e3, but moving it changes the defense of d5 and e4 tactics.

WHAT WHITE WANTS

White keeps the king flexible and may answer the knight attack by creating a pin or counterattacking in the center.

THREE HABITS TO BUILD

1. Find the attacked bishop.
2. Do not confuse a threat with a free capture.
3. Keep ...f5 subordinate to the center.

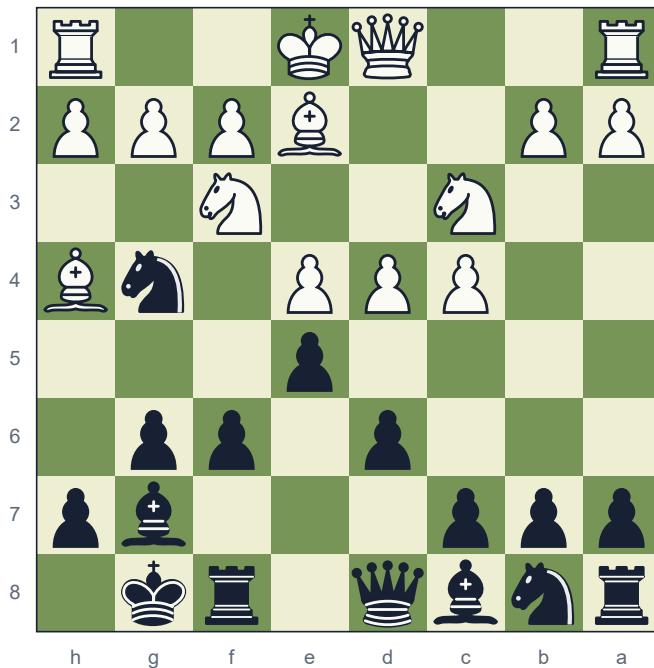
Original repertoire choices and commentary. Public opening names and move-order references, plus local Stockfish checks. Sources and method: Booklet 26.

01 Bg5 pins the queen line

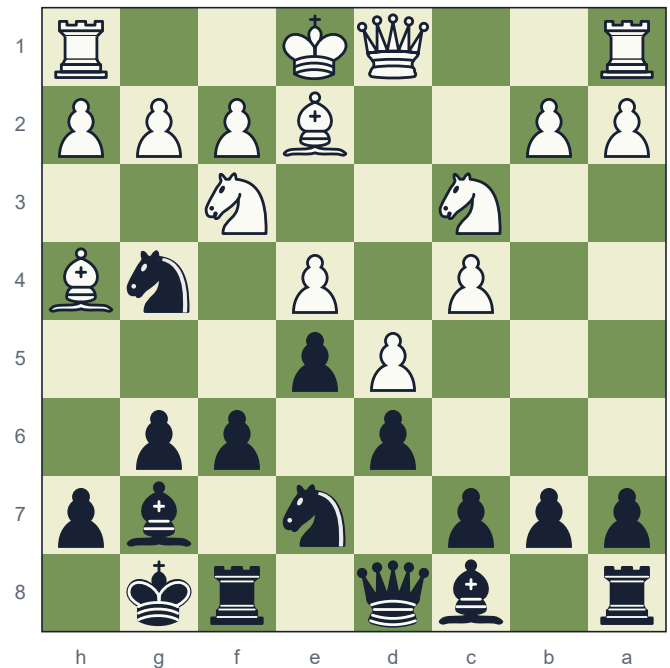
STUDY LINE 08-01

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. Be3 Ng4 8. Bg5 f6 9. Bh4 Nc6 10. d5 Ne7

Selected anchor ends with 9... Nc6. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 9... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

Bg5 creates pressure along the diagonal toward d8. ...f6 blocks that diagonal and asks the bishop to move.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

After development, compare d5 and central exchanges. The f-pawn is now on f6, so a later ...f5 takes another move.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

The pawn on f6 can weaken dark squares. Keep the g7 bishop and king coordinated.

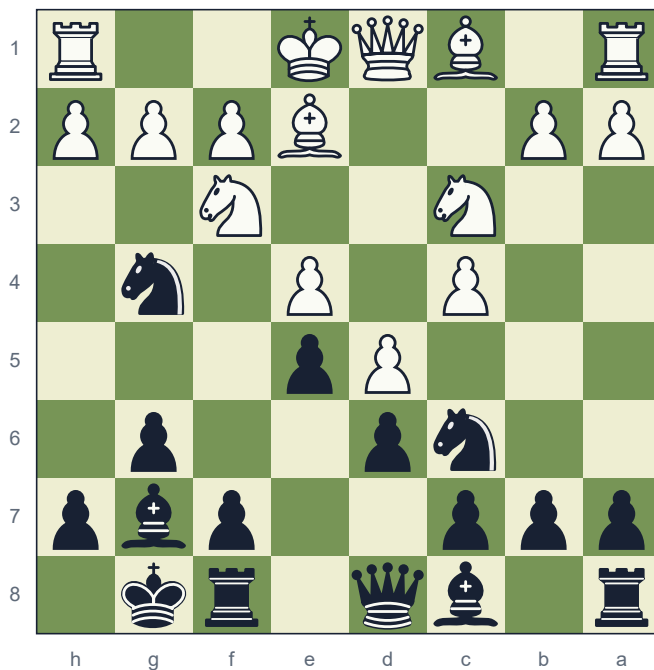
REMEMBER A defensive pawn move changes your attacking timetable.

02 White retreats to c1

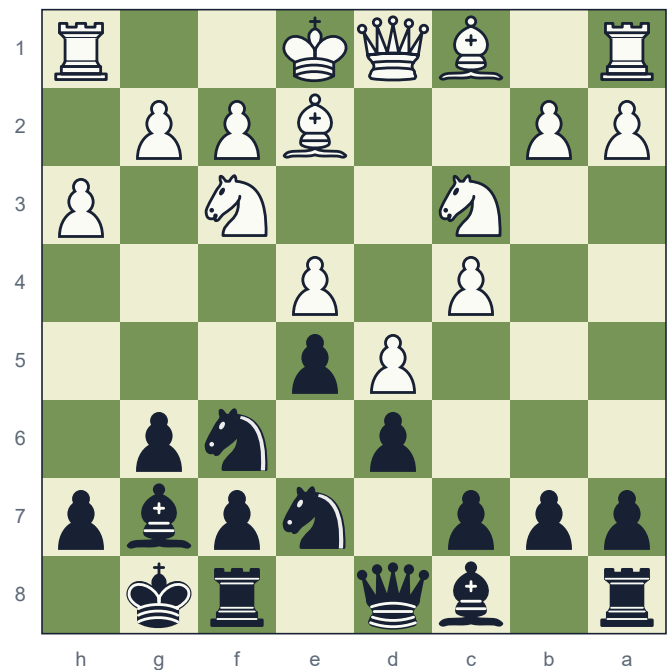
STUDY LINE 08-02

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. Be3 Ng4 8. Bc1 Nc6 9. d5 Ne7 10. h3 Nf6

Selected anchor ends with 9... Ne7. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 9... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

Black gains development while the bishop returns home. The center can then lock with a different knight placement from the standard Classical.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Return the g4 knight to f6 or seek a useful route; avoid leaving it exposed to h3 and f3.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

A developed knight is not automatically well placed. It can become a target after the bishop retreats.

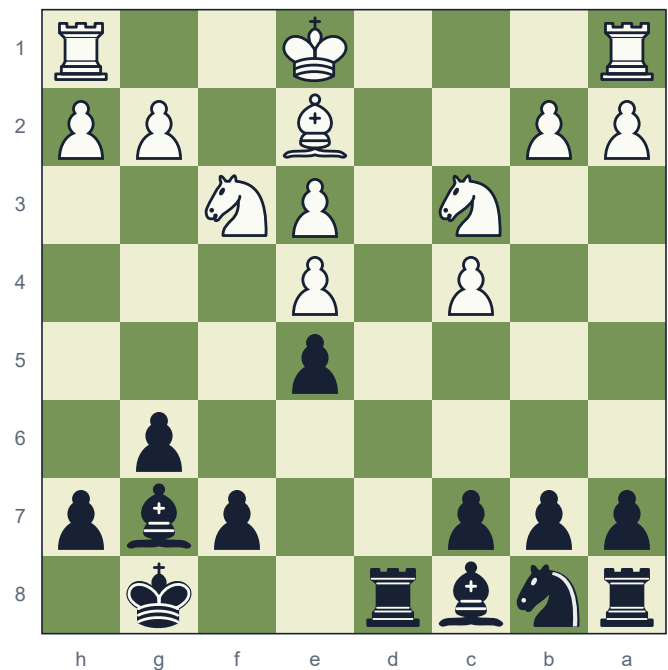
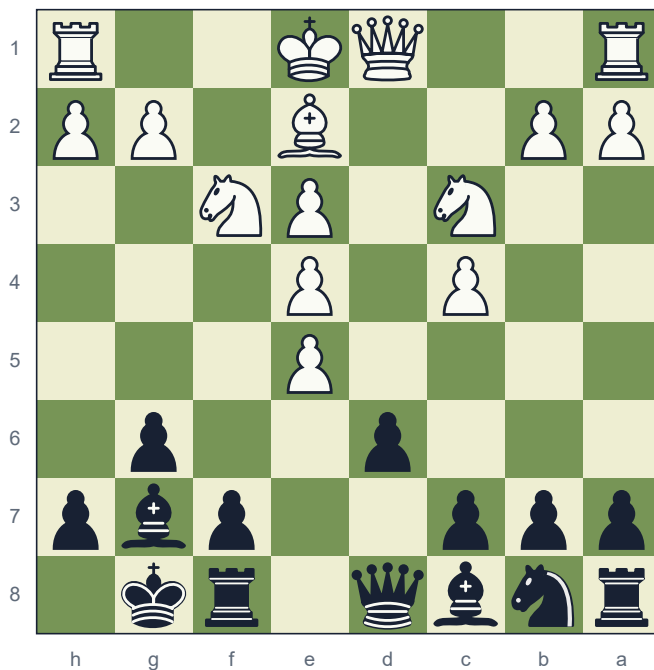
REMEMBER Use the gained tempo to improve coordination.

03 White exchanges the center

STUDY LINE 08-03

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. Be3 Ng4 8. dxe5 Nxe3 9. fxe3 dxe5 10. Qxd8 Rxd8

Selected anchor ends with 9... dxe5. Later moves show one checked example.



WHY THESE MOVES

Black trades the g4 knight for the e3 bishop. White's f-pawn recapture changes the structure and opens the f-file.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

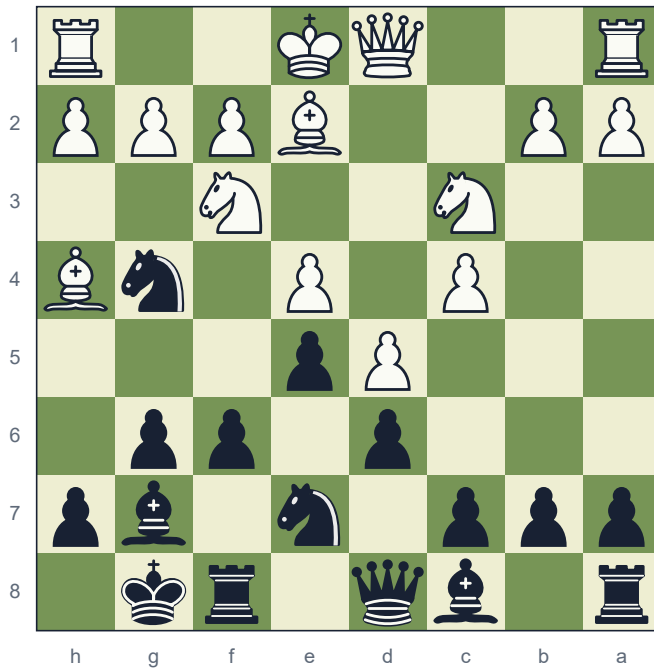
Develop the queenside and put pressure on e4 and e3. White may use the open f-file, so do not neglect defense.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

Doubled pawns are not an immediate win. White has central control and rook activity as compensation.

REMEMBER A structural concession always has a practical price.

Review before your next game



Main-line endpoint - White to move

1. CLASSIFY THE CENTER

The center is still fluid. The f6 knight can attack e3, but moving it changes the defense of d5 and e4 tactics.

2. NAME WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White keeps the king flexible and may answer the knight attack by creating a pin or counterattacking in the center.

3. CHOOSE A USEFUL JOB

After development, compare d5 and central exchanges. The f-pawn is now on f6, so a later ...f5 takes another move.

RECONSTRUCT

Set up the starting position and play this booklet's main line. Before every Black move, state White's threat and why your move is safe. Stop at the first point you cannot explain.

BRANCH TEST

Choose one alternative White move from this booklet. Explain what changed: a defender, a pawn contact, a king choice or a tempo. Then reconstruct the response without looking.

PRACTICE

Play the endpoint against a partner or a chess program, switching colors after one game. Record the first new position and your candidate moves. Use the line ID to find it in Repertoire_Lines.pgn.